Rahul Gandhi's ability to instil confidence in minority communities, particularly in Kerala, has strengthened his secular credentials. This stands in stark contrast to the divisive ideology of the BJP. The BJY has further enhanced these credentials, clearing the negative image branding attempts by the BJP.

'Politics is about branding,' says V.D. Satheesan. 'The BJP, with its powerful communication machinery, attempted to tarnish Rahul Gandhi's image, but the BJY has erased all that.' Today, Rahul Gandhi stands tall, not only as a political force, but also as a moral and spiritual leader, towering above his contemporaries.

The BJY has shown that the political space created by past leaders such as Mahatma Gandhi, Jawaharlal Nehru and Kamaraj Nadar is not lost. Rahul Gandhi has reclaimed it.

Young India yearns for a leader such as Rahul Gandhi, someone liberal, progressive and capable of challenging the system, dressing and speaking like them and displaying agility. The fact that he walked for thousands of kilometres resonated deeply with them. Another significant change was how Rahul Gandhi shed the derogatory 'Pappu' image slapped on him by the BJP. He not only proved that he wasn't 'Pappu', but also challenged everyone to do what he did—walk and connect with ordinary people, without fear and fatigue.

He transcended party lines and legacy to embrace the greater good of the nation as the larger goal. Here was a man who, though often ignored, woke the nation up, addressed issues and united people, to defeat the divide-and-rule strategy.

Preserving this unity is paramount. It is the bedrock of our democracy, empowering us to face challenges with determination. The BJY is not just a journey—it's a movement towards a more inclusive, equitable and united India, an era where unity's collective strength paves the way for a brighter future.

Final Word